

Chapter 5 — Pastoralists in the Modern World

The one-line point: Nomadic pastoralism is not a leftover from the past — it is a **precisely engineered response to environments where settled farming fails**, and its central mechanism is **movement**, which lets a pasture recover before it is grazed again. The colonial state's entire programme — settlement, reservation, taxation, criminalisation — attacked **exactly that mechanism**. *"Pastoralists are not relics of the past."*

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Syllabus Classification

Field	Value
Subject	History → Modern India + Africa · Social and environmental history
Sub-discipline	Pastoral economies · colonial land and revenue policy · ecology
Period	c. 1800 – present (core: 1850–1950)
Prelims (GS Paper I & III)	★★★★ Community names and their regions, the four colonial laws, <i>bugyal/bhabar/kafila</i> , Maasai figures — all directly askable, and the community–region matching question is a standard Prelims format
Mains (GS Paper I)	★★★★ " <i>colonization... effect on the society</i> "; marginalised communities; and note that this chapter is about AFRICA too, which almost nothing else in your syllabus covers at this level
Also feeds	★★★★ GS3 Environment (common property resources, the "tragedy of the commons" argument, grazing and carrying capacity, rangeland ecology, drought), GS3 Agriculture (animal husbandry, transhumance, manuring of fields), GS1 Geography ★★★★★ (transhumance is a syllabus topic in its own right), GS2 (denotified tribes — the descendants of the "criminal tribes"), Indian Society ★★★★★, Essay ★★★★★ (mobility and the state; who counts as productive)
Weightage	★★★★ — small chapter, disproportionately useful in GS3
Overlaps with	★★★★ Ch.4 of this book (the same four instruments, applied to people who move), Class 8 Ch.4 (tribal displacement), Ch.2 of this book (the Bolsheviks' "harsh discouragement of nomadism" — the same instinct from the opposite ideology)

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this chapter you should be able to:

- ☐ **Name each pastoral community with its region and its animal.** ★★★★★
- ☐ **Describe the Himalayan annual cycle** — winter base, summer pasture, and the route. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Explain why the plateau/desert cycle is driven by a different variable** than the mountain cycle. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Explain the Dhangar–Konkani peasant exchange** — an example of ecological complementarity. ★★★★★
- ☐ ★★★★★ **State the FOUR colonial measures and what each did** — Waste Land Rules, Forest Acts, Criminal Tribes Act, Grazing Tax.
- ☐ **Explain the ecological argument for movement** — and why restricting it degraded the pastures. ★★★★★

- ☐ **List the ways pastoralists coped**, including after 1947. ★★ ★
- ☐ **Name the African pastoral communities** and give the continental figures. ★★ ★
- ☐ **Give the four reasons the Maasai lost their grazing lands.** ★★ ★★
- ☐ **Explain what drought does to a confined pastoralist**, with the 1933–34 figures. ★★ ★★
- ☐ **Explain the TWO levels of social change** in Maasai society. ★★ ★★
- ☐ **Write two similarities** between Indian and Maasai experience. ★★ ★★

Start Here: Why This Chapter Exists

★★★ ★ **"Pastoralists rarely enter the pages of history textbooks.** When you read about the economy... you learn about **agriculture and industry**. Sometimes you read about artisans; **but rarely about pastoralists. As if their lives do not matter. As if they are figures from the past who have no place in modern society.**"*

Definition: Nomads are *"people who **do not live in one place** but **move from one area to another to earn their living.**"*

And the framing sentence from the Section II introduction, which is the thesis of both Chapters 4 and 5:

★★★★ ★ **"These communities are **very much part of the modern world we live in today. They are not simply survivors from a bygone era.**"* ... "We also cannot understand the problems of **modernisation unless we look at its impact on the environment.**"**

1 Pastoral Nomads and Their Movements

1.1 In the mountains — the cycle is driven by **SNOW**

THE HIMALAYAN ANNUAL CYCLE (all four communities share it)

WINTER	HIGH MOUNTAINS UNDER SNOW -> herds in the LOW HILLS of the SIWALIK range -> "the DRY SCRUB FORESTS here provided pasture"
END APRIL	the northern march begins
SUMMER	"the snow melted and the mountainsides were LUSH GREEN. The VARIETY OF GRASSES that sprouted provided RICH NUTRITIOUS FORAGE"
END SEPT	the downward journey begins, back to the winter base

Community	Where	Animals	The route
★ ★ ★ Gujar Bakarwals	Jammu and Kashmir	goat and sheep	Winter in the Siwaliks ; by end April they cross the PIR PANJAL passes and enter the valley of Kashmir ; ★ several households travel together in a KAFILA . Many migrated to the region in the 19th century in search of pastures
★ ★ ★ Gaddi shepherds	Himachal Pradesh	goats and sheep	Winter in the Siwaliks ; by April north to ★ LAHUL and SPITI ; then higher mountain meadows when the passes clear; return by September ★ <i>stopping in the villages of Lahul and Spiti to reap their summer harvest and sow their winter crop</i>
★ ★ ★ Gujar cattle herders	Garhwal and Kumaon	cattle (buffaloes)	Winter in the dry forests of the ★ BHABAR ; summer in the high meadows — the ★ BUGYALS . "Many of them were originally from Jammu and came to the UP hills in the nineteenth century in search of good pastures"
★ ★ Bhotiyas, Sherpas, Kinnauris	the Himalayas	—	"This pattern of cyclical movement between summer and winter pastures was typical of many pastoral communities of the Himalayas "

Words: ★ *Bhabar* — a dry forested area below the foothills of Garhwal and Kumaun. ★ *Bugyal* — vast meadows in the high mountains (NCERT: "vast natural pastures... **above 12,000 feet**. They are **under snow in the winter** and **come to life after April**... by monsoon these pastures are **thick with vegetation and carpeted with wild flowers**"). ★ *Kafila* — the group formed when several households travel together.

★ ★ ★ ★ And the key ecological sentence — underline it, it recurs three times in this chapter:

*"All of them had to **adjust to seasonal changes** and **make effective use of available pastures in different places**. When the pasture was **exhausted or unusable** in one place they moved their herds and flock to new areas. **THIS CONTINUOUS MOVEMENT ALSO ALLOWED THE PASTURES TO RECOVER; IT PREVENTED THEIR OVERUSE.**"*

🌀 This is the intellectual core of the chapter, and it answers NCERT's Question 1 completely. Movement is not restlessness or backwardness; **it is a rotation system**, the exact pastoral equivalent of the **12–18 year fallow in shifting cultivation** you met in Chapter 4. Both are **regeneration cycles**, and the colonial state **misread both as waste** because in each case land was sitting idle at the moment an official looked at it.

Source A — G.C. Barnes on the Gujjars of Kangra, 1850–55 (useful for the gendered division of labour, which NCERT asks about):

"In the hills the Gujjars are **exclusively a pastoral tribe** — they cultivate scarcely at all. The **Gaddis keep flocks of sheep and goats** and the Gujjars' wealth consists of buffaloes. These people **live in the skirts of the forests**, and maintain their existence **exclusively by the sale of the milk, ghee, and other produce of their herds**. ★ **THE MEN graze the cattle, and frequently lie out for weeks in the woods tending their herds. THE WOMEN repair to the markets every morning with baskets on their heads, with little earthen pots filled with milk, butter-milk and ghee...** During the hot weather the Gujjars usually **drive their herds to the upper range**, where the buffaloes **rejoice in the rich grass which the rains bring forth** and at the same time gain **from the temperate climate and the immunity from venomous flies that torment their existence in the plains.**"

★ ★ Note the last clause — it gives a second reason for the summer migration besides grass: escape from the biting flies of the plains. And note the division of labour: men herd and camp out for weeks; women carry the produce to market daily. The household is a two-location enterprise.

📍 1.2 On the plateaus, plains and deserts — the cycle is driven by the MONSOON

★ ★ ★ ★ ★ "Unlike the mountain pastoralists, it was NOT THE COLD AND THE SNOW that defined the seasonal rhythms of their movement: rather it was THE ALTERNATION OF THE MONSOON AND DRY SEASON."*

This one contrast is the most likely conceptual question from the chapter. Learn it as a pair:

MOUNTAIN PASTORALISTS	PLATEAU / DESERT PASTORALISTS
Driver: SNOW	Driver: THE MONSOON
Winter in the LOW hills	Monsoon on the DRY PLATEAU
Summer in the HIGH meadows	Dry season in the COASTAL tracts
They go UP when it warms	They LEAVE the coast when the rains come
Because: high pasture is under snow in winter	Because: SHEEP CANNOT TOLERATE WET MONSOON CONDITIONS -- only BUFFALOES like the swampy, wet coastal conditions

Community	Where	Animals / work	The cycle
★ ★ ★ Dhangars	Maharashtra — ★ population in the early 20th century estimated at 467,000	"Most were shepherds , some were blanket weavers , and still others were buffalo herders "	Monsoon on the central plateau — "semi-arid, low rainfall, poor soil, covered with thorny scrub. Nothing but dry crops like BAJRA could be sown here ", but in the monsoon it became a vast grazing ground . ★ By October they harvested their bajra and moved WEST ; after about a month's march they reached the ★ KONKAN
★ ★ Gollas	Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh — dry central plateau "covered with stone and grass"	herded cattle	Dry season → coastal tracts ; left when the rains came
★ ★ Kurumas and Kurubas	same	reared sheep and goats and sold woven blankets	"They lived near the woods, cultivated small patches of land, engaged in a variety of petty trades and took care of their herds"
★ ★ ★ Banjaras	villages of Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra	graziers	"In search of good pastureland... they moved over long distances, selling PLOUGH CATTLE and other goods to villagers in exchange for GRAIN AND FODDER "
★ ★ ★ Raikas	deserts of Rajasthan — Barmer, Jaisalmer, Jodhpur, Bikaner	★ Maru (desert) Raikas herded CAMELS ; another group reared sheep and goat	*"rainfall meagre and uncertain ... harvests fluctuated every year . Over vast stretches no crop could be grown . So the Raikas COMBINED CULTIVATION WITH PASTORALISM ."* Monsoon in their home villages where pasture was available; by October , when grazing grounds were dry and exhausted , they moved out in search of pasture and water , returning the next monsoon. (Their settlement is called a dhandi .)

📍 The Dhangar–Konkan exchange — ★★★★★ the best example in the chapter

THE DHANGARS ARRIVE IN THE KONKAN (after their October march)
"a FLOURISHING agricultural tract with HIGH RAINFALL and RICH SOIL"

"Here the shepherds were WELCOMED BY KONKANI PEASANTS."

WHY? The KHARIF harvest has just been cut, and the fields
"had to be FERTILISED and MADE READY for the RABI harvest."

THE DHANGAR FLOCKS GIVE:	manure (they "MANURED THE FIELDS")
THE DHANGAR FLOCKS TAKE:	fodder (they "FED ON THE STUBBLE")
THE KONKANI PEASANTS GIVE:	"supplies of RICE which the shepherds took back to the plateau WHERE GRAIN WAS SCARCE"

WITH THE ONSET OF THE MONSOON the Dhangars leave the Konkan
-- "THE SHEEP COULD NOT TOLERATE THE WET MONSOON CONDITIONS."

★★★★★ Notice how many problems this one arrangement solves at once. The peasant gets **free fertiliser exactly when the field needs it**; the shepherd gets **free fodder from stubble that would otherwise rot**; the shepherd carries **rice back to a grain-scarce plateau**; and the flock **leaves before the monsoon that would kill the sheep**. Nobody designed this. It emerged because **two ecologies with opposite seasons were adjacent**. For GS3, this is your model answer on **integrated crop–livestock systems** — and it explains why breaking pastoral mobility damaged *settled agriculture too*, not just the pastoralists.

Source B — Buchanan on the Gollas of Mysore, early 19th century, on how a pastoral household actually splits its labour:

*"Their families live in **small villages near the skirt of the woods**, where they **cultivate a little ground**, and keep some of their cattle, **selling in the towns the produce of the dairy**. Their families are very numerous, **seven to eight young men in each being common**. **Two or three of these attend the flocks in the woods**, while the remainder cultivate their fields, and supply the towns with **firewood, and with straw for thatch**."*

🌀 NCERT asks: "Why do you think pastoral groups often live on the edges of forests?" — Because the edge is where **two** resources meet. From the forest: **grazing, firewood, fodder, thatch**. From the settled side: **a little cultivable ground and a town to sell dairy in**. The edge is not marginal; it is **optimal**. Answer it that way.

🧠 The skills the life demanded — quote this in any answer on pastoralism

★★★★★ *"the life of these pastoral groups was **sustained by a careful consideration of a host of factors**. They had to judge **how long the herds could stay in one area**, and know **where they could find water and pasture**. They needed to **calculate the timing of their movements**, and ensure that they **could move through different territories**. They had to **set up a relationship with farmers on the way**, so that the herds could **graze in harvested fields and manure the soil**. They combined a **range of different activities — cultivation, trade, and herding — to make their living**."*

★ ★ ★ Read that as a list of competences: ecological judgement, hydrological knowledge, logistical timing, diplomacy across territories, and a diversified livelihood portfolio. Everything the colonial state called "wandering" was in fact **skilled work under uncertainty**. And note **Fig. 9**: the Maru Raikas kept a **genealogist** who "*recounts the history of the community*" — "*Such oral traditions give pastoral groups their own sense of identity... they can tell us **how a group looks at its own past.***" **A community without writing is not a community without history.**

2 Colonial Rule and Pastoral Life

NCERT's summary of what happened, in one sentence: *"Under colonial rule, the life of pastoralists changed dramatically. **Their grazing grounds shrank, their movements were regulated, and the revenue they had to pay increased. Their agricultural stock declined and their trades and crafts were adversely affected.**"**

⚖️ **THE FOUR MEASURES** — ★ ★ ★ ★ NCERT asks about these by name; know each one's *purpose* and its *effect*

1 The Waste Land Rules (from the mid-19th century)

The state's motive	<i>"the colonial state wanted to transform all grazing lands into cultivated farms. Land revenue was one of the main sources of its finance. By expanding cultivation it could increase its revenue collection" — and at the same time produce more ★ jute, cotton, wheat and other agricultural produce required in England</i>
★ ★ ★ The doctrine	<i>"To colonial officials all uncultivated land appeared to be UNPRODUCTIVE: it produced NEITHER REVENUE NOR AGRICULTURAL PRODUCE. It was seen as 'WASTE LAND' that needed to be brought under cultivation"</i>
The mechanism	<i>"Waste Land Rules were enacted in various parts of the country. By these Rules uncultivated lands were TAKEN OVER AND GIVEN TO SELECT INDIVIDUALS. These individuals were granted various concessions and encouraged to settle these lands. Some of them were made HEADMEN of villages in the newly cleared areas"</i>
★ ★ ★ The catch	<i>"In most areas the lands taken over were ACTUALLY GRAZING TRACTS USED REGULARLY BY PASTORALISTS. So expansion of cultivation inevitably meant the decline of pastures and a problem for pastoralists"</i>

🔗 ★ ★ ★ ★ This is *terra nullius* again, in Indian dress (Chapter 4, Box 1 and Source A). **"Waste" is not a description — it is a legal category invented to make transfer look like improvement.** The land was in continuous, seasonal, productive use; it simply produced **milk, ghee, wool and manure** rather than **taxable grain**. **Whatever the state cannot count, it calls waste.** That sentence will serve you in an essay.

2 The Forest Acts (from the mid-19th century)

Reserved forests	Forests producing commercially valuable timber like deodar or sal were declared 'Reserved' — ★ "NO PASTORALIST WAS ALLOWED ACCESS to these forests"
Protected forests	" <i>some customary grazing rights of pastoralists were granted but their movements were severely restricted</i> "
★★ The official justification	*"The colonial officials believed that grazing destroyed the saplings and young shoots of trees that germinated on the forest floor. The herds trampled over the saplings and munched away the shoots. This prevented new trees from growing. "*
★★★★ The permit regime	*"Even in the areas they were allowed entry, their movements were regulated. They needed a PERMIT for entry. The TIMING of their entry and departure was specified, and the NUMBER OF DAYS they could spend in the forest was LIMITED. Pastoralists could no longer remain in an area EVEN IF forage was available, the grass was succulent and the undergrowth in the forest was ample. They had to move because THE FOREST DEPARTMENT PERMITS THAT HAD BEEN ISSUED TO THEM NOW RULED THEIR LIVES. The permit specified the periods in which they could be legally within a forest. If they overstayed they were liable to fines. "*

Word: ★ Customary rights — rights that people are used to by custom and tradition.

★★★★ The deepest point in the chapter is in that permit paragraph, and it is easy to read past. The pastoralists had *always* moved. What changed was **who decided when**. Movement timed by **grass, water and weather** was replaced by movement timed by **a piece of paper. The state did not abolish mobility — it confiscated the judgement that governed it.** And a schedule that ignores the actual state of the pasture is precisely what produces **both** premature departure and overgrazing.

Source C — H.S. Gibson, Deputy Conservator of Forests, Darjeeling, 1913, stating the forester's logic with perfect clarity: "*...forest which is used for grazing cannot be used for any other purpose and is unable to yield timber and fuel, which are the main LEGITIMATE forest produce...*" 🎯 The word to seize on is "legitimate." Grazing was not judged harmful; it was judged **illegitimate** — an unauthorised use of an asset whose proper output had been defined in advance as timber. **Compare Chapter 4: "foresters and villagers had very different ideas of what a good forest should look like."**

3 The Criminal Tribes Act, 1871 — ★★★★★

THE SUSPICION

"British officials were SUSPICIOUS OF NOMADIC PEOPLE. They DISTRUSTED mobile craftsmen and traders who hawked their goods in villages, and pastoralists who CHANGED THEIR PLACES OF RESIDENCE EVERY SEASON."

THE PREFERENCE

"The colonial government WANTED TO RULE OVER A SETTLED POPULATION. They wanted the rural people to LIVE IN VILLAGES, IN FIXED PLACES WITH FIXED RIGHTS ON PARTICULAR FIELDS. SUCH A POPULATION WAS EASY TO IDENTIFY AND CONTROL."

THE EQUATION

"THOSE WHO WERE SETTLED WERE SEEN AS PEACEABLE AND LAW ABIDING; THOSE WHO WERE NOMADIC WERE CONSIDERED TO BE CRIMINAL."

THE LAW -- 1871, THE CRIMINAL TRIBES ACT

"By this Act many communities of CRAFTSMEN, TRADERS AND PASTORALISTS were classified as CRIMINAL TRIBES."

THEY WERE STATED TO BE CRIMINAL BY NATURE AND BIRTH."

THE CONSEQUENCES

- "expected to live ONLY IN NOTIFIED VILLAGE SETTLEMENTS"
- "NOT ALLOWED TO MOVE OUT WITHOUT A PERMIT"
- "THE VILLAGE POLICE KEPT A CONTINUOUS WATCH ON THEM"

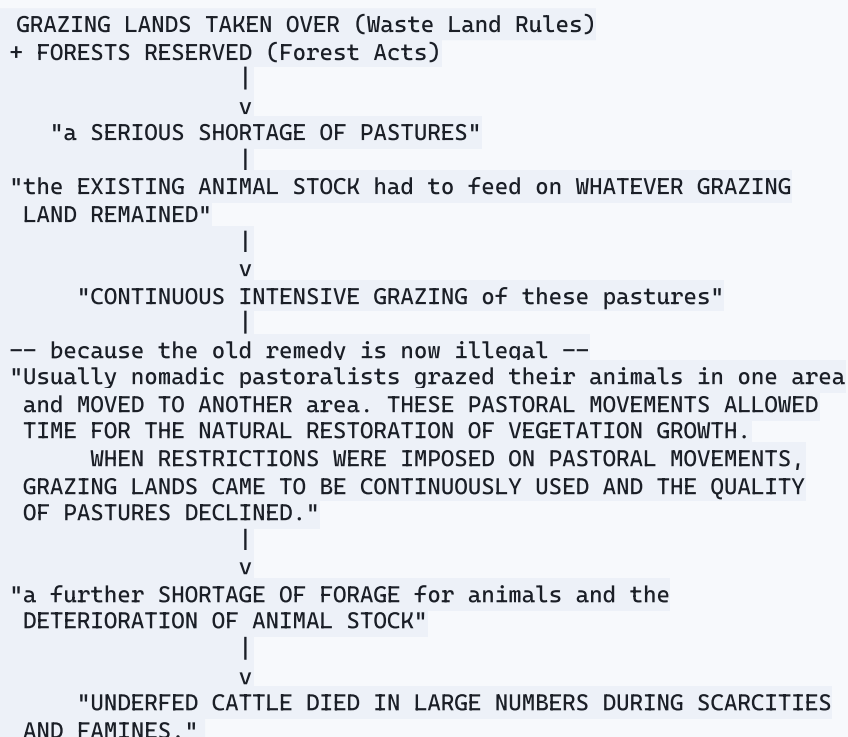
★★★★★ "Criminal by nature and birth" — pause on that phrase. This is **not** a law against acts; it is a law against **descent**. A child was born a criminal. ★ **Compare Chapter 3's Nuremberg Laws**, where citizenship was made a matter of blood: **two very different regimes, and in both, the decisive move is converting a social category into a hereditary one**. Note the difference too — the British goal was **control and legibility**, not extermination — but the legal technique is recognisably the same. 🔗 ★★★★★ **GS2 link worth knowing**: the Act was **repealed in 1952**, and the affected communities are today called **denotified tribes (DNTs)** — the **Renke** and **Idate** Commissions and the **Development and Welfare Board for DNTs** deal with their continuing marginalisation. **The stigma outlived the statute by seventy years**. If a question touches DNTs, this chapter is where the story starts.

4 The Grazing Tax (from the mid-19th century)

The logic	"to expand its revenue income , the colonial government looked for every possible source of taxation . So tax was imposed on land, on canal water, on salt, on trade goods, and even on ANIMALS "
★★ The tax	"Pastoralists had to pay tax on EVERY ANIMAL they grazed on the pastures... The tax per head of cattle went up rapidly and the system of collection was made increasingly efficient "
★★★★ 1850s–1880s — collection by contractors	"the right to collect the tax was AUCTIONED OUT TO CONTRACTORS . These contractors tried to extract AS HIGH A TAX AS THEY COULD to recover the money they had paid to the state and earn as much profit as they could within the year "
★★★★ By the 1880s — direct collection	"the government began collecting taxes DIRECTLY from the pastoralists . Each of them was given a PASS . To enter a grazing tract, a cattle herder had to show the pass and pay the tax . The number of cattle heads he had and the amount of tax he paid was entered on the pass "

★★★★ Two things to notice. First, the **contractor system was structurally extortionate**: a man who has bought a one-year right will squeeze maximum revenue within that year, because he bears **none** of the long-term cost of ruining the herd. (You saw the identical dynamic in **Chapter 4** with railway timber contractors "*cutting trees indiscriminately*", and in **Class 8 Ch.3** with revenue farming.) Second, **the pass is the real innovation** — it converts a herd into a **countable, documented, checkable** thing. **Taxation required legibility, and legibility required that people stop moving unrecorded.** All four measures are ultimately the same project.

📌 2.1 How these changes affected pastoralists — ★★★★★ the causal chain



★★★★ State the irony explicitly in any answer, because it is the chapter's sharpest **argument**: the colonial state restricted grazing **on the stated ground that grazing damaged vegetation** — and the restriction itself **produced the overgrazing it claimed to prevent**. Confining herds to a shrinking area **guarantees** continuous use of the same ground. **Mobility was the conservation mechanism; abolishing it created the degradation.** 📌 For GS3 this is directly usable against the naive "**tragedy of the commons**" **argument**: the commons here was not ungoverned. It was governed by **rotation, seasonal timing and inter-community agreements** — exactly like Bastar's village forests in Chapter 4.

Source D — the Royal Commission on Agriculture, 1928, confirming it in the state's own words:

*"**The extent of the area available for grazing has gone down tremendously** with the extension of area under cultivation because of **increasing population, extension of irrigation facilities, acquiring the pastures for Government purposes** — for example, defence, industries and agricultural experimental farms. [Now] **breeders find it difficult to raise large herds. Thus their earnings have gone down. The quality of their livestock has deteriorated, dietary standards have fallen and indebtedness has increased.**"* 🎯 ★★★★★ Note the **five** causes the Commission itself lists — population, irrigation, **defence, industries, experimental farms** — and note that it records the outcome as a **four-fold decline**: earnings, livestock quality, **diet**, and rising **debt**. This is an **official** source admitting the damage, which makes it far more persuasive in an answer than a nationalist assertion would be.

📖 2.2 How pastoralists coped — ★★ note that this section is about **agency**, not victimhood

Strategy	Detail
Reduce the herd	"Some reduced the number of cattle in their herds, since there was not enough pasture to feed large numbers"
Find new pastures	"Others discovered new pastures when movement to old grazing grounds became difficult"
★★★ The 1947 case — Partition redrew a pastoral route	" After 1947 , the camel and sheep herding Raikas could no longer move into SINDH and graze their camels on the banks of the INDUS , as they had done earlier. The new political boundaries between India and Pakistan stopped their movement. So they had to find new places to go. In recent years they have been migrating to HARYANA where sheep can graze on agricultural fields after the harvests are cut — this is the time that the fields need the manure that the animals provide "
The rich settle	"Over the years, some richer pastoralists began buying land and settling down, giving up their nomadic life. Some became settled peasants cultivating land, others took to more extensive trading "
★ The poor fall	*"Many poor pastoralists, on the other hand, BORROWED MONEY FROM MONEYLENDERS to survive. At times they LOST THEIR CATTLE AND SHEEP and became LABOURERS , working on fields or in small towns."*

★★★★ The Raika case is the perfect illustration of how a political event becomes an ecological one. Partition was a decision about sovereignty in Delhi and Karachi; for the Raikas it meant **the Indus bank was gone**. And their solution — **re-establishing the manure-for-stubble exchange in Haryana** — is exactly the Dhangar–Konkan arrangement, rebuilt on new ground. **The institution survived even though the route did not.**

★★★★ And NCERT's conclusion to the Indian half — quote it:

*"Yet, pastoralists not only continue to survive, in many regions their numbers have **EXPANDED** over recent decades. When pastureland in one place was closed to them, they **changed the direction of their movement, reduced the size of the herd, combined pastoral activity with other forms of income and adapted to the changes in the modern world.** ★ Many ecologists believe that **IN DRY REGIONS AND IN THE MOUNTAINS, PASTORALISM IS STILL ECOLOGICALLY THE MOST VIABLE FORM OF LIFE.**"*

3 Pastoralism in Africa

The scale — learn these figures

Fact	Figure
 Africa's share of world pastoralists	over half the world's pastoral population lives there
 Africans depending on pastoral activity today	over 22 million
 The communities	Bedouins, Berbers, Maasai, Somali, Boran and Turkana
Where they live	" <i>semi-arid grasslands or arid deserts where rainfed agriculture is difficult</i> "
What they raise	cattle, camels, goats, sheep and donkeys
What they sell	milk, meat, animal skin and wool
Other income	"Some also earn through trade and transport , others combine pastoral activity with agriculture ; still others do a variety of odd jobs to supplement their meagre and uncertain earnings"

The Maasai — the case study

Fact	Detail
 Where and how many	"live primarily in east Africa: 300,000 in southern KENYA and another 150,000 in TANZANIA "
 The name	*"The title Maasai derives from the word Maa . Maa-sai means ' MY PEOPLE '"*
Subsistence	"traditionally nomadic and pastoral people who depend on MILK AND MEAT for subsistence"
 Their view of cultivation	*"Maasai believed that tilling the land for crop farming is a CRIME AGAINST NATURE. Once you cultivate the land, it is no longer suitable for grazing. "* — though " <i>forced by changing conditions, the Maasai have grown dependent on food produced in other areas such as maize meal, rice, potatoes, cabbage</i> "

📖 3.1 Where have the grazing lands gone? —

★★★★★ **FOUR** reasons, and NCERT asks this directly

REASON 1 -- THE INTERNATIONAL BOUNDARY (1885)

"Before colonial times, Maasailand stretched over a VAST area FROM NORTH KENYA TO THE STEPPES OF NORTHERN TANZANIA."

"In the late nineteenth century, European imperial powers SCRAMBLED for territorial possessions in Africa, slicing up the region into different colonies."

"In 1885, MAASAILAND WAS CUT INTO HALF with an international boundary between BRITISH KENYA and GERMAN TANGANYIKA."

REASON 2 -- WHITE SETTLEMENT

"the BEST GRAZING LANDS were gradually taken over for WHITE SETTLEMENT and the Maasai were PUSHED INTO A SMALL AREA in south Kenya and north Tanzania."

"THE MAASAI LOST ABOUT 60 PER CENT OF THEIR PRE-COLONIAL LANDS. They were confined to an ARID ZONE with UNCERTAIN RAINFALL and POOR PASTURES."

REASON 3 -- THE EXPANSION OF CULTIVATION

"From the late nineteenth century, the British colonial government in east Africa also ENCOURAGED LOCAL PEASANT COMMUNITIES TO EXPAND CULTIVATION. As cultivation expanded, PASTURELANDS WERE TURNED INTO CULTIVATED FIELDS."

"In pre-colonial times, the Maasai pastoralists had DOMINATED their agricultural neighbours both ECONOMICALLY AND POLITICALLY. BY THE END OF COLONIAL RULE THE SITUATION HAD REVERSED."

REASON 4 -- GAME RESERVES

"Large areas of grazing land were also turned into GAME RESERVES like the MAASAI MARA and SAMBURU NATIONAL PARK in Kenya and SERENGETI PARK in Tanzania."

"Pastoralists were NOT ALLOWED TO ENTER these reserves; they could NEITHER HUNT ANIMALS NOR GRAZE THEIR HERDS."

"Very often these reserves were in areas that had TRADITIONALLY BEEN REGULAR GRAZING GROUNDS for Maasai herds. THE SERENGETI NATIONAL PARK was created over 14,760 SQ KM OF MAASAI GRAZING LAND."

★★★★★ **Reason 4 deserves special attention, and it is the point most worth making in a GS3 answer.** The **Serengeti and Maasai Mara** — the places the world now holds up as conservation triumphs — were **created by evicting the people who had grazed there for centuries**. This is the origin of what is called **"fortress conservation"**: the assumption that nature is protected by **removing humans** from it. Set it beside **Chapter 4's** finding that Indian forests survived **because** villages protected them as sacred groves, and you have both sides of the modern conservation debate in a single book. **And NCERT gives you the bitter modern coda in a caption:** the areas *"hardest hit by drought and food shortage"* are **near Amboseli National Park**, which in one year generated *"approximately 240 million Kenyan Shillings (about \$3.5 million US) from tourism"* — while the **Kilimanjaro Water Project** cuts through these communities and ★ **"the villagers are barred from using the water for irrigation or for livestock."** Revenue flows out; thirst stays behind.

On Tanganyika (a boxed note worth knowing): *"Britain conquered what had been German East Africa during the First World War. In 1919 Tanganyika came under British control. It attained independence in 1961 and united with Zanzibar to form TANZANIA in 1964."**

🚧 3.2 The borders are closed

*"In the nineteenth century, African pastoralists could **move over vast areas** in search of pastures... **From the late nineteenth century, the colonial government began imposing various restrictions on their mobility.**"*

Restriction	Detail
Reserves	"other pastoral groups were also forced to live within the confines of special reserves. The boundaries of these reserves became the limits within which they could now move "
★ Permits	" not allowed to move out with their stock without special permits. And it was difficult to get permits without trouble and harassment. Those found guilty of disobeying the rules were severely punished "
★★ Markets and trade	"Pastoralists were also not allowed to enter the markets in white areas. In many regions, they were prohibited from participating in any form of trade "
The reasoning	" White settlers and European colonists saw pastoralists as dangerous and savage — people with whom all contact had to be minimised "
★★★ The contradiction	*"Cutting off all links was, however, NEVER REALLY POSSIBLE, because white colonists HAD TO DEPEND ON BLACK LABOUR to bore mines, and build roads and towns."*

★★★ That last line is the recurring hypocrisy of settler colonialism, and it is worth stating plainly: the people declared **too dangerous to trade with** were simultaneously **indispensable to dig the mines and build the towns.** Segregation was never separation; it was a mechanism for cheap labour.

Source E — the Kaokoland herders of Namibia, 1949. They had traditionally moved between Kaokoland and nearby Ovamboland, selling **skin, meat and other trade products** in neighbouring markets, "*All this was stopped with the new system of territorial boundaries.*" Their own words: *"**We have difficulty. We cry. WE ARE IMPRISONED. We do not know why we are locked up. WE ARE IN JAIL. We have no place to live... We cannot get meat from the south... Our sleeping skins cannot be sent out... Ovamboland is closed for us.** We lived in Ovamboland for a long time. We want to take our cattle there, also our sheep and goats. **The borders are closed. THE BORDERS PRESS US HEAVILY. WE CANNOT LIVE.**"* 🌀 "*We are in jail*" — said by people who had been moved nowhere. The prison was built by drawing a line. **This is the most quotable source in the chapter** and it works for any answer about borders, mobility, or the human cost of partition — including India's own.

Source F — a magistrate's instruction to police, south-west Africa, 24 November 1937: *"**Passes to enter the Territory should not be given to these Natives unless exceptional circumstances necessitate their entering... The object of the above proclamation is to RESTRICT THE NUMBER OF NATIVES ENTERING the Territory and to KEEP A CHECK ON THEM, and ordinary visiting passes should therefore NEVER be issued to them.**"* 🔒 ★★★ Note the identical instrument on two continents: the PASS. A grazing pass in India recording head of cattle and tax paid; an entry pass in Namibia recording permission to exist in a place. **(And in South Africa the same device would become the pass laws of apartheid.)** The document is how a state converts a person's movement into a permission.

🌱 3.3 When pastures dry — ★★★★★ the argument, then the numbers

THE PRINCIPLE

"Drought affects the life of pastoralists everywhere. When rains fail and pastures are dry, cattle are likely to STARVE UNLESS THEY CAN BE MOVED to areas where forage is available.

THAT IS WHY, TRADITIONALLY, PASTORALISTS ARE NOMADIC; they move from place to place. THIS NOMADISM ALLOWS THEM TO SURVIVE BAD TIMES AND AVOID CRISES."

WHAT COLONIALISM DID

"But from the colonial period, the Maasai were BOUND DOWN TO A FIXED AREA, CONFINED WITHIN A RESERVE, and PROHIBITED FROM MOVING in search of pastures. They were CUT OFF FROM THE BEST GRAZING LANDS and forced to live within a SEMI-ARID TRACT PRONE TO FREQUENT DROUGHTS."

THE RESULT

"Since they COULD NOT SHIFT THEIR CATTLE to places where pastures were available, LARGE NUMBERS OF MAASAI CATTLE DIED OF STARVATION AND DISEASE in these years of drought."

★★★★★ The figures — these make an answer:

Enquiry / period	Figure
An enquiry in 1930 — Maasai holdings in Kenya	720,000 cattle · 820,000 sheep · 171,000 donkeys
★★★★★ In just two years of severe drought, 1933 and 1934	OVER HALF the cattle in the Maasai Reserve DIED

*"As the area of grazing lands shrank, **the adverse effect of the droughts INCREASED IN INTENSITY**. The frequent bad years led to **a steady decline of the animal stock**."*

★★★★★ State the causal point precisely, because it is subtle and it is what earns marks: the drought of 1933–34 was a **natural** event; **the death of half the herd was not**. Drought had always occurred; **nomadism was the insurance policy against it**. Colonial confinement did not cause the drought — **it cancelled the insurance**. This is the clearest available example of how a **"natural disaster" is made lethal by a political decision**, and it transfers directly to answers on **famine, disaster management and vulnerability** in GS1 and GS3.

👤 3.4 Not all were equally affected — ★★★★★ the TWO levels of social change

Pre-colonial Maasai society:

ELDERS

"formed the RULING GROUP and met in PERIODIC COUNCILS to DECIDE ON THE AFFAIRS of the community and SETTLE DISPUTES."

WARRIORS

"consisted of YOUNGER PEOPLE, mainly responsible for THE PROTECTION OF THE TRIBE. They DEFENDED the community and ORGANISED CATTLE RAIDS."

"RAIDING WAS IMPORTANT IN A SOCIETY WHERE CATTLE WAS WEALTH. It is through raids that THE POWER OF DIFFERENT PASTORAL GROUPS WAS ASSERTED. Young men came to be recognised as members of the warrior class when they PROVED THEIR MANLINESS by raiding the cattle of other pastoral groups and participating in wars."

"THEY, HOWEVER, WERE SUBJECT TO THE AUTHORITY OF THE ELDERS."

-> the organising principle is AGE

What the British did:

Measure	Effect
★★ Appointed chiefs	"They appointed CHIEFS of different sub-groups of Maasai , who were made responsible for the affairs of the tribe "
★★ Banned raiding and warfare	"The British imposed various restrictions on raiding and warfare "
★★★ The consequence	"Consequently, the traditional authority of BOTH elders AND warriors was adversely affected "

And what the appointed chiefs became:

THE CHIEFS	THE POOR PASTORALISTS
"often ACCUMULATED WEALTH over time"	"depended ONLY on their livestock"
"had a REGULAR INCOME with which they could buy ANIMALS, GOODS AND LAND"	"did NOT HAVE THE RESOURCES TO TIDE OVER BAD TIMES"
"LENT MONEY TO POOR NEIGHBOURS who needed cash TO PAY TAXES"	"In times of WAR AND FAMINE, THEY LOST NEARLY EVERYTHING."
"Many began LIVING IN TOWNS, and became INVOLVED IN TRADE. Their wives and children stayed back in the villages to look after the animals."	"They had to GO LOOKING FOR WORK IN THE TOWNS. Some eked out a living as CHARCOAL BURNERS, others did ODD JOBS."
"These chiefs MANAGED TO SURVIVE THE DEVASTATIONS OF WAR AND DROUGHT. They had BOTH PASTORAL AND NON-PASTORAL INCOME, and could BUY ANIMALS WHEN THEIR STOCK WAS DEPLETED."	The lucky could get more regular work in ROAD OR BUILDING CONSTRUCTION."

★★★★ NCERT's own summary — memorise this two-part structure, it is the answer to any question on Maasai social change: *
"The social changes in Maasai society occurred at **TWO LEVELS**. First, the traditional difference based on **AGE**, between the elders and warriors, was **DISTURBED**, though it did not break down entirely. Second, A **NEW DISTINCTION BETWEEN THE WEALTHY AND POOR PASTORALISTS DEVELOPED**."*

🎯★★★★ The mechanism deserves one sentence of your own in an answer, because it is genuinely illuminating. A society stratified by **age** is one where **everyone eventually reaches the top** — every warrior becomes an elder. A society stratified by **wealth** is one where **position is permanent and heritable**. Colonial rule did not merely add inequality; it changed the axis of inequality from one that time erased to one that time compounded. And it did so through the most ordinary of instruments: **appointing chiefs and paying them a regular income**. Note also that this is the same "**colonial intermediary**" story you know from **Class 8 Ch.3** — the Permanent Settlement's zamindars, the ryotwari's headmen, and here the appointed chief who ends up **lending money to his neighbours so they can pay the taxes he collects**.

❏ The Conclusion — and it is the whole chapter's argument

★★★★★ "So we see that pastoral communities in different parts of the world are affected in a variety of different ways by changes in the modern world. **New laws and new borders affect the patterns of their movement.** With increasing restrictions on their mobility, pastoralists find it difficult to move in search of pastures. **As pasture lands disappear grazing becomes a problem, while pastures that remain deteriorate through continuous overgrazing.** Times of drought become times of crises, when cattle die in large numbers.

YET, PASTORALISTS DO ADAPT TO NEW TIMES. They change the paths of their annual movement, reduce their cattle numbers, press for rights to enter new areas, exert political pressure on the government for relief, subsidy and other forms of support, and demand a right in the management of forests and water resources.

★★★★★ **PASTORALISTS ARE NOT RELICS OF THE PAST. THEY ARE NOT PEOPLE WHO HAVE NO PLACE IN THE MODERN WORLD.** Environmentalists and economists have increasingly come to recognise that **PASTORAL NOMADISM IS A FORM OF LIFE THAT IS PERFECTLY SUITED TO MANY HILLY AND DRY REGIONS OF THE WORLD.**"*

🎯 **Read the list of adaptations again — it ends in politics.** *Press for rights, exert political pressure, demand a right in the management of forests and water resources.* **The chapter closes with pastoralists as claimants in a democracy, not as a vanishing curiosity.** That is the note to end any answer on.

● Prelims traps

Trap	The truth
"Gaddis are of Jammu and Kashmir"	★ ★ Gaddi = HIMACHAL PRADESH (Lahul and Spiti). Gujjar Bakarwals = JAMMU AND KASHMIR (Pir Panjal → Kashmir valley)
"Bhabar means high mountain meadow"	★ ★ Bhabar = a DRY FORESTED AREA BELOW THE FOOTHILLS of Garhwal and Kumaun. Bugyal = the VAST HIGH MEADOWS (above 12,000 ft)
"Kafila is a type of pasture"	★ The group formed when several households travel together
"Dhangars are of Rajasthan"	★ ★ Dhangars = MAHARASHTRA (~467,000 in the early 20th century). Raikas = RAJASTHAN (Barmer, Jaisalmer, Jodhpur, Bikaner)
"Gollas reared sheep and sold blankets"	★ ★ Gollas herded CATTLE . Kurumas and Kurubas reared sheep and goats and sold woven blankets — all in Karnataka/Andhra
"Maru Raikas herded sheep"	★ Maru (desert) Raikas herded CAMELS ; another Raika group reared sheep and goat
"Banjaras were only found in Rajasthan"	★ UP, Punjab, Rajasthan, MP and Maharashtra — selling plough cattle for grain and fodder
"Dhangars moved to the Konkan in the monsoon"	★ ★ They LEFT the Konkan at the onset of the monsoon — sheep cannot tolerate wet conditions. They arrived in October, after harvesting bajra
"Mountain and plateau pastoralists both moved because of cold"	★ ★ ★ Mountains = snow ; plateau/desert = the alternation of monsoon and dry season
"The Criminal Tribes Act was passed in 1891"	★ ★ 1871 — communities declared " <i>criminal by nature and birth</i> ", confined to notified village settlements , needing a permit to move , watched by the village police . Repealed 1952
"Waste Land Rules gave land to pastoralists"	★ ★ Uncultivated land was taken over and given to SELECT INDIVIDUALS with concessions; some were made village headmen . Most of it was grazing tract
"Grazing tax was always collected directly"	★ ★ Auctioned to CONTRACTORS between the 1850s and 1880s; direct collection from the 1880s , using a PASS recording cattle heads and tax paid
"Pastoralists could enter protected forests freely"	★ No access at all to RESERVED forests; in PROTECTED forests some customary rights, but movement severely restricted by permit, timing and duration
"Over half the world's pastoralists live in Asia"	★ ★ Africa — and over 22 million Africans depend on pastoral activity
"Maasailand was divided in 1885 between Britain and France"	★ ★ British Kenya and GERMAN Tanganyika, 1885 . Tanganyika came under Britain in 1919 , independent 1961 , united with Zanzibar to form Tanzania in 1964
"The Maasai lost about 30% of their lands"	★ ★ ★ About 60 PER CENT
"Serengeti was created over 1,476 sq km"	★ ★ 14,760 sq km of Maasai grazing land
"Half the Maasai cattle died over a decade of drought"	★ ★ ★ Over half the cattle in the Maasai Reserve died in just TWO years — 1933 and 1934 . The 1930 enquiry recorded 720,000 cattle, 820,000 sheep, 171,000 donkeys
"Maasai warriors were the ruling group"	★ ★ ELDERS ruled and met in periodic councils; warriors were younger men responsible for protection and raids, and were subject to the authority of the elders

● Mains angles

- ★ ★ ★ ★ "Explain why nomadic tribes need to move from one place to another. What are the advantages to the environment of this continuous movement?" (NCERT Q1.) — Why they move:

seasonal availability of pasture (snow in the mountains; the monsoon/dry alternation on the plateau); water; the animals' own tolerances (sheep cannot take the wet monsoon, buffaloes can; buffaloes cannot climb above ~11,000 ft); escape from **venomous flies** in the plains; and the **manure-for-stubble** exchange with settled farmers. **Environmental advantage:** *"This continuous movement **allowed the pastures to recover; it prevented their overuse**" — a **rotation and regeneration system**, plus **nutrient transfer** from pasture to cropland via manure.*

- ★★★★★ **"Discuss why the colonial government brought in the Waste Land Rules, Forest Acts, Criminal Tribes Act and Grazing Tax, and how each changed the lives of pastoralists."** (NCERT Q2 — the flagship question. Give purpose AND effect for each.)

Law	Why it was brought in	How it changed pastoral life
Waste Land Rules	Revenue — uncultivated land yielded neither revenue nor produce; plus jute, cotton, wheat for England	Grazing tracts taken over and handed to select individuals; pastures shrank
Forest Acts	To secure commercially valuable timber (deodar, sal) ; belief that grazing destroyed saplings	No entry to reserved forests ; permits, fixed timing and duration elsewhere; finest for overstaying — <i>"the permits... now ruled their lives"</i>
Criminal Tribes Act 1871	Desire to rule a settled, identifiable, controllable population ; nomads equated with criminals	Declared criminal by birth ; confined to notified settlements ; permit to move ; continuous police watch
Grazing Tax	To expand revenue from every possible source	Tax per head of animal , rising rapidly; contractors extorted (1850s–80s); then the pass system recording herd and tax

- ★★★★★ **"Give reasons to explain why the Maasai community lost their grazing lands."** (NCERT Q3 — the four reasons: the 1885 boundary; white settlement taking the best land, **60% lost**; encouraged expansion of peasant cultivation; and **game reserves** — Serengeti alone over **14,760 sq km**.)
- ★★★★★ **"Write about two changes that were similar for Indian pastoralists and the Maasai herders."** (NCERT Q4 — pick any two and develop them:)
 - ★ **Grazing land lost to cultivation and to state reservation** — Waste Land Rules and Forest Acts in India; white settlement, encouraged peasant cultivation and game reserves in Maasailand.
 - ★ **Mobility restricted by permits and borders** — forest permits and the grazing pass in India, reserve boundaries and entry passes in Africa; and **new political borders cutting old routes** — **Maasailand halved in 1885**, the **Raikas cut off from Sindh in 1947**, the **Kaokoland herders cut off from Ovamboland**.
 - Confinement made drought lethal** — underfed cattle dying in Indian scarcities; **over half the Maasai herd dead in 1933–34**.
 - Social differentiation** — richer pastoralists bought land and settled or traded, poorer ones fell into debt and wage labour, in **both** societies.
 - The state's preference for a settled, legible population** — *"criminal by nature and birth"* in India; pastoralists seen as *"dangerous and savage"* in Africa.
- ★★★★★ **GS3: "Restrictions on pastoral mobility caused the very degradation they were meant to prevent." Examine.** — The strongest analytical answer available from this chapter: movement as a **rotation/regeneration mechanism**; confinement → **continuous intensive grazing** → pasture decline → forage shortage → stock deterioration → **mass deaths in drought**; supported by the **Royal Commission of 1928**; and extended to the critique of the naive **"tragedy of the commons"**, since the commons here was governed by **rotation, seasonal timing and inter-community arrangements**.
- ★★★★★ **"Fortress conservation": examine the costs of excluding communities from protected areas.** — Serengeti, Maasai Mara, Samburu; Amboseli's **240 million shillings of tourism revenue** beside

drought-hit neighbours **barred from the Kilimanjaro water**; contrast with **Chapter 4's sacred groves** and community patrolling, and with India's **FRA 2006** and **eco-development/JFM** models.

- ★★★★★ **GS2/Society: from "criminal tribes" to "denotified tribes."** — The 1871 Act, repeal in **1952**, and the continuing stigma; the Renke and Idate Commissions; the Development and Welfare Board for DNTs.
- ★★★★★ **"Pastoralism is not a survival from the past but an adaptation to specific ecologies."** **Discuss.** — Use the closing paragraph, the ecologists' verdict on dry regions and mountains, the expansion of pastoral numbers in recent decades, and the Raikas' post-1947 reinvention in Haryana.

Cross-links to build now

- ★★★★★ **Ch.4 of this book** — the **same four instruments** (land classification, reservation, criminalisation, taxation) applied to forest dwellers; **"waste land" is *terra nullius*** again; the **12–18 year fallow** and **pastoral rotation** are the same idea; **"criminal tribes"** appears in both chapters (**Korava, Karacha, Yerukula** in Ch.4).
- **Ch.2 of this book** — the Bolsheviks' **"harsh discouragement of nomadism"** in Central Asia. **Two opposed ideologies, one shared hostility to people who move.**
- **Ch.3 of this book** — the Criminal Tribes Act's *"criminal by nature and birth"* beside the Nuremberg Laws' citizenship by blood: **the technique of converting a social category into a hereditary one.**
- **Class 8 Ch.3 and Ch.4** — revenue farming by contractors; the creation of colonial intermediaries; tribal displacement and Birsa Munda.
- **GS1 Geography** — **transhumance**, Himalayan pastoral systems, semi-arid rangelands.
- **GS3** — common property resources, carrying capacity, drought vulnerability, animal husbandry, integrated crop–livestock systems, protected-area management.

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Nomads	People who do not live in one place but move from one area to another to earn their living
Bhabar	A dry forested area below the foothills of Garhwal and Kumaun
Bugyal	Vast meadows in the high mountains — above 12,000 ft, under snow in winter
Kafila	The group formed when several households travel together
Dhar	The high meadows from which Gaddi shepherds descend by September
Dhandi	The settlement of the Maru Raika camel herders
Kharif	The autumn crop , usually harvested between September and October
Rabi	The spring crop , usually harvested after March
Stubble	Lower ends of grain stalks left in the ground after harvesting
Customary rights	Rights that people are used to by custom and tradition
Waste Land Rules	Rules under which uncultivated land was taken over and given to select individuals
Criminal Tribes Act, 1871	Act classifying craftsmen, traders and pastoralists as criminal by nature and birth
Grazing tax	Tax per head of animal grazed; collected via contractors , later via a pass
Maa-sai	"My People" — from the word Maa
Game reserve	Protected area from which pastoralists were barred from hunting and grazing

60-Second Recap

1. Nomads move to earn a living, and NCERT's point is that they are "not simply survivors from a bygone era."
2. ★ **Mountains — the cycle is set by SNOW.** Gujar Bakarwals (J&K, goat and sheep) winter in the Siwaliks, cross the **Pir Panjal** in a **kafila** to the **Kashmir valley** by end April, return by end September. **Gaddis** (Himachal, sheep and goats) go to **Lahul and Spiti**, and on the way back **reap the summer harvest and sow the winter crop**. **Gujjar cattle herders** (Garhwal and Kumaon) move between the **bhabar** in winter and the **bugyals** in summer. Also the **Bhotiyas, Sherpas and Kinnauris**.
3. ★★ **The ecological principle:** *"This continuous movement **allowed the pastures to recover; it prevented their overuse.**"*
4. ★ **Plateau, plains and desert — the cycle is set by the MONSOON, not the cold.** **Dhangars** (Maharashtra, ~467,000) spend the monsoon on the dry plateau growing **bajra**, march **west in October** to the **Konkan**, where they **manure the fields and feed on the stubble** and are given **rice** to carry home — and leave before the monsoon **because sheep cannot tolerate wet conditions**. **Gollas** herd **cattle**; **Kurumas and Kurubas** rear sheep and goats and **sell blankets**. **Banjaras** sell **plough cattle** for **grain and fodder** across UP, Punjab, Rajasthan, MP and Maharashtra. **Raikas** of the Rajasthan desert **combine cultivation with pastoralism**; the **Maru Raikas** herd camels.
5. ★ **The work demanded judgement** — how long a herd could stay, where water and pasture lay, timing, passage through others' territory, and **relationships with farmers on the way**.
6. ★★ **Under colonial rule:** *"their grazing grounds shrank, their movements were regulated, and the revenue they had to pay increased."*
7. ★★ **Waste Land Rules** — all uncultivated land looked "**unproductive**", so it was **taken over and given to select individuals; in most areas it was grazing tract**.
8. ★★ **Forest Acts** — **no access at all to reserved forests** (deodar, sal); in protected forests, **permits fixing entry, exit and duration**, with **finest for overstaying**, because officials believed **grazing destroyed saplings**.
9. ★★ **Criminal Tribes Act, 1871** — the state *"wanted to rule over a settled population... easy to identify and control"*; **"those who were settled were seen as peaceable; those who were nomadic were considered to be criminal."** Communities declared **criminal by nature and birth**, confined to **notified settlements**, needing **permits**, under **continuous police watch**.
10. ★★ **Grazing tax** — per head of animal; **auctioned to contractors 1850s–1880s** who extorted to recoup their bid; then **direct collection with a pass** recording cattle heads and tax paid.
11. ★★★ **The result:** pastures shrank → **continuous intensive grazing** → pasture quality declined → forage shortage → stock deterioration → **underfed cattle died in large numbers in scarcities and famines**. The **Royal Commission on Agriculture, 1928** confirmed falling earnings, deteriorating livestock, **falling dietary standards and rising indebtedness**.
12. ★★ **Coping:** smaller herds; new pastures; **the Raikas, cut off from Sindh and the Indus after 1947, now migrate to Haryana** to graze harvested fields that need manure; **richer pastoralists bought land, settled or traded; poorer ones borrowed, lost their stock and became labourers**. Yet **numbers have expanded in many regions**, and ecologists hold pastoralism **still the most viable form of life in dry regions and mountains**.
13. ★★ **Africa holds over half the world's pastoralists; over 22 million depend on it** — **Bedouins, Berbers, Maasai, Somali, Boran, Turkana**. The **Maasai** number **300,000** in southern Kenya and **150,000** in Tanzania; *Maa-sai* means "**my people**"; they held that **tilling the land is a crime against nature**.
14. ★★★ **Four reasons the Maasai lost their land:** the **1885 boundary** between British Kenya and German Tanganyika cut Maasailand in half; **white settlement took the best grazing** and left them

60% poorer in land, confined to an **arid zone**; **peasant cultivation was encouraged** and pastures became fields — **reversing the Maasai's pre-colonial dominance over their agricultural neighbours**; and **game reserves** — **Maasai Mara, Samburu, Serengeti**, the last created over **14,760 sq km** of their grazing land.

15. ★★ **The borders closed:** confinement to reserves, **special permits** obtainable only "*with trouble and harassment*", **exclusion from white markets and often from all trade** — while "*white colonists had to depend on black labour to bore mines and build roads and towns.*" The **Kaokoland herders of Namibia, 1949:** *"**We are in jail... The borders press us heavily. We cannot live.**"*
16. ★★★ **Drought:** nomadism was the defence against it. Confined, the Maasai could not move — an enquiry in **1930** recorded **720,000 cattle, 820,000 sheep, 171,000 donkeys**, and **in just two years, 1933 and 1934, over half the cattle in the Reserve died.**
17. ★★★ **Social change at two levels:** the **age-based distinction between elders (who ruled in councils) and warriors (who protected and raided)** was **disturbed** by the British **appointing chiefs** and **banning raiding**; and a **new distinction between wealthy and poor pastoralists developed** — chiefs accumulated wealth, **lent money to neighbours who needed cash for taxes**, moved to towns and traded, and **survived war and drought**, while the poor **lost everything and became charcoal burners, odd-jobbers and construction labour.**
18. ★★★★★ **The conclusion:** "*Pastoralists are not relics of the past... pastoral nomadism is a form of life that is perfectly suited to many hilly and dry regions of the world*" — and they adapt by **changing routes, reducing herds, pressing for rights, exerting political pressure, and demanding a role in the management of forests and water resources.**

Test Yourself

Prelims style

1. Match: **Gaddi / Gujjar Bakarwal / Dhangar / Raika** with **Maharashtra / Rajasthan / Himachal Pradesh / Jammu and Kashmir**. — **Gaddi–Himachal · Gujjar Bakarwal–J&K · Dhangar–Maharashtra · Raika–Rajasthan.**
2. *Bhabar* and *bugyal* refer respectively to — **a dry forested area below the foothills of Garhwal and Kumaun, and vast meadows in the high mountains.**
3. Consider: (i) Dhangars reached the Konkan in October after harvesting bajra. (ii) They left the Konkan at the onset of the monsoon. (iii) Konkani peasants resented their arrival. — **(i) and (ii) only. They were welcomed — the flocks manured the fields before the rabi sowing.**
4. The Criminal Tribes Act was passed in — **1871**; communities were declared criminal **by nature and birth**, confined to **notified village settlements**, and needed a **permit to move.**
5. Under the grazing tax, between the 1850s and 1880s the right to collect was — **auctioned out to contractors**; from the **1880s** the government collected **directly**, issuing each herder a **pass.**
6. Maasailand was divided by an international boundary in 1885 between — **British Kenya and German Tanganyika**; the Maasai eventually lost about **60 per cent** of their pre-colonial lands.
7. The Serengeti National Park was created over — **14,760 sq km of Maasai grazing land.**
8. In the two drought years 1933 and 1934 — **over half the cattle in the Maasai Reserve died.**

Mains style

9. Explain why nomadic tribes need to move from one place to another. What are the advantages to the environment of this continuous movement? **(150 words)** ★
10. Discuss why the colonial government in India brought in the Waste Land Rules, the Forest Acts, the Criminal Tribes Act and the Grazing Tax. In each case explain how the law changed the lives of pastoralists. **(250 words)** ★ — *the flagship question*
11. Give reasons to explain why the Maasai community lost their grazing lands. **(150 words)** ★
12. Write about two changes that were similar for Indian pastoralists and the Maasai herders. **(150 words)** ★
13. "Restrictions on pastoral mobility produced the very degradation they were meant to prevent." Examine. **(250 words)** ★ — *GS3 crossover*
14. Examine the social changes brought about in Maasai society under colonial rule. **(150 words)**
15. "Pastoralism is not a survival from the past but an adaptation to specific ecologies." Discuss. **(250 words)**

Self-check (out loud, no notes):

- Name six pastoral communities with region and animal.
- Explain the difference between what drives the mountain cycle and the plateau cycle.
- Describe the Dhangar–Konkan exchange in both directions.
- Name the four colonial measures and give purpose and effect for each.
- Explain the causal chain from land alienation to cattle deaths.
- Give the four reasons the Maasai lost their grazing lands, with two figures.
- Give the 1930 enquiry figures and what happened in 1933–34.
- State the two levels of social change in Maasai society, and why the change of axis mattered.

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*This completes the five printed chapters of NCERT Class IX India and the Contemporary World – I. The three chapters NCERT moved behind a QR code — **Peasants and Farmers, Clothing: A Social History** and **History and Sport: The Story of Cricket** — are dealt with in the supplement noted on the [index](#).*